

Design Document

Project Description:

Nipun's Personal Homepage is a multi-page personal homepage built for the CS5610 Web Development class at Northeastern University. The site serves as a personal website showcasing my bio, my interests, and things I enjoy like travel.

There are three pages:

1. About Me: Introduces who I am with a photo, a short bio about my pivot from Political Science at Rutgers into AI/ML engineering at Northeastern, and a contact section linking to my email and LinkedIn.

2. Bucket List: A bucket list of places I want to visit, displayed as interactive flip cards. Each card shows the site name and location on the front, and reveals a photo, a short historical bio, and my personal reason for wanting to visit on the back. The list can be filtered by continent (Africa, Asia, Europe, Americas) to make it easy to explore by region. Sites I've already visited are marked with a "Visited" badge and styled distinctly.

3. Interests (AI): An AI-generated page covering my professional interests in AI and legal technology, along with personal hobbies including weight lifting, snowboarding, basketball, and travel.

The site is built with HTML5, CSS3, and vanilla JavaScript with ES6 modules. There is no backend as everything runs in the browser. The overall design is a minimal off-white palette with light blue and warm brown accents to create a clean, modern feel that lets the content breathe. Furthermore, the goal of this project was to showcase my personal skills and interests to give individuals a way to learn about me and contact me if interested, while also demonstrating my web development skills through interactive features like card filtering and 3D flip animations.

User Personas/Stories:

Persona 1: AI/ML Recruiter at a Legal Tech Startup

Name: Sarah Chen, 34 **Role:** Senior Technical Recruiter @ a legal-tech AI startup **Location:** New York, NY

Background: Sarah recruits engineers for a Series B startup building AI tools for law firms; contract review, legal research automation, that kind of thing. She gets a lot of generic CS resumes, so she pays attention when she sees someone with an unconventional background that actually maps to her industry. She typically spends 30-45 seconds on a portfolio before deciding to dig in or move on.

Scenario: Sarah sees Nipun's LinkedIn profile and notices the "Political Science to AI/ML" pivot which is exactly the kind of cross-disciplinary background her CEO loves for legal-tech roles. She clicks through to his personal homepage. The first thing she sees is the photo and the line about "combining both fields to make legal work more efficient, accessible, and fair." She skims the About Me, scrolls to the Contact section, and copies his email and LinkedIn into her ATS to follow up. Before leaving, she clicks the Interests (AI) tab to confirm the legal-tech interest is real, and not just a buzzword in his bio.

User Stories:

1. As a recruiter, I want to immediately see Nipun's professional pitch on the homepage so I can decide in 30 seconds whether he's a fit.
2. As a recruiter, I want to find Nipun's email and LinkedIn in a clearly labeled contact section so I can reach out about an opportunity.
3. As a recruiter, I want to verify his stated interest in AI/legal tech by reading more on a dedicated page so I know it's a real focus, not resume filler.

Persona 2: Fellow Graduate Student

Name: Aarushi Chandane, 25 **Role:** First-year Align CS Master's student at Northeastern
Location: Boston, MA

Background: Aarushi is in the same CS Masters program as Nipun and browses classmates' portfolios to learn techniques, see what's possible at this stage of the program, and benchmark her own work. She's comfortable reading code on GitHub and will inspect-element a site if something catches her eye. She's looking for ideas for her own upcoming web dev project.

Scenario: She sees Nipun's homepage link in the class Slack and clicks through. The flip-card animation on the Bucket List page catches her attention so she wants to try something similar for her project. She opens dev tools to look at the CSS for the 3D transform. Then she scrolls through Nipun's bucket list and notices Petra and Angkor Wat are also on his own list. She clicks through to the GitHub repo to look at the source code structure and see how Nipun organized his JS modules and CSS.

User Stories:

1. As a classmate, I want to see what interactive features Nipun built so I can get ideas for my own project.
2. As a classmate, I want to find the GitHub repository link so I can read the source code and learn from it.
3. As a classmate, I want to compare his bucket list places to mine so we have something to talk about in class

Persona 3: Family Member Checking In

Name: Priya Jayakumar, 52 **Role:** Nipun's aunt, works in accounting **Location:** Edison, NJ

Background: Priya isn't technical and doesn't really know what a "homepage" is, but Nipun's mom mentioned he built a website for school. She's proud of him for going back to school for his Masters and curious to see what he's been working on. She'll open the link on her phone, scroll for a minute or two, and probably share it with the family group chat if she likes it.

Scenario: Priya gets a link from her sister in the family group chat with a "look what Nipun made!" message. She opens it on her phone. She reads the About Me paragraph and likes that she can finally explain what he's doing in plain words. She scrolls down and clicks over to the Bucket List page out of curiosity. She's surprised and proud to see Chichen Itza marked as "Visited" as she remembers when he went on that trip. She clicks a few cards to flip them and read his reasons for wanting to visit each place. She likes that one of his bucket list items is Rome because she's been telling him to go for years. She copies the link and forwards it to the family group chat with a heart emoji.

User Stories:

1. As a family member, I want to read about Nipun's work and interests in plain language so I understand what he's been up to.
2. As a family member, I want the site to work cleanly on my phone so I can browse without struggling with tiny text or broken layouts.
3. As a family member, I want to easily share the site with the rest of the family so everyone can see what he's been working on.

Design Mockups:

